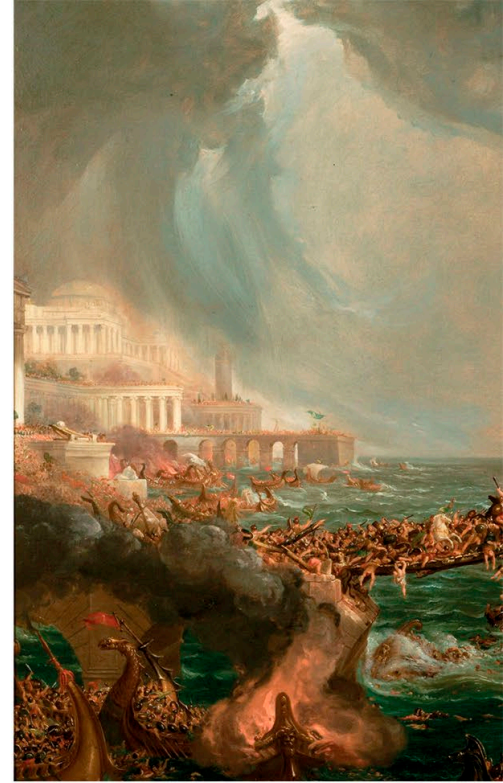


c. 450 CE KINGDOM OF AKSUM AT ITS HEIGHT

The Christian kingdom of Aksum (centred on modern Eritrea and Ethiopia), reached its zenith in the 5th century CE. The first sub-Saharan state to issue coinage, its merchants traded as far as Alexandria, linking into Mediterranean networks, and its rulers erected huge stelae in the capital, Aksum.

▷ King Ezana's Stela, Aksum, 4th century CE



△ *The Course of Empire, Destruction* by Thomas Cole imagines the sack of Rome

420 CE

439 CE The Vandals capture Carthage,
capital of Roman North Africa



426 CE ST AUGUSTINE OF HIPPO COMPLETES CITY OF GOD

After a career as a professor in Milan, Augustine converted to Christianity and became first a priest and then a bishop in Hippo in his native North Africa. His writings helped reconcile Classical philosophy and Christian teaching, and in his *City of God* he told the history of the world through divine providence, refuting suggestions that the sack of Rome in 410 CE had been divine punishment for the rejection of paganism.

◁ *St Augustine's City of God*, Spanish translation

450 CE Execution of Cui Hao, chief architect of the Northern Wei reforms in China

“The world is passing away, the world is losing its grip, the world is short of breath.”

ST AUGUSTINE OF HIPPO,
SERMON 81